Anaiah Quinn
CS 5388

Festivo: Sprint 3 Field Notes

These are my notes from three in-person interviews conducted on 10/12/26. The purpose of the interviews was to understand how people currently plan events, what tools they use, and what challenges they experience.

Interview 1: Wedding and Travel Coordination

Event: Sister's wedding in California, approximately five months ago
Role: Helped coordinate transportation for family members

Event Experience

- Behavior: Helped organize transportation for approximately five people traveling from El Paso to California for sister's wedding.
- Behavior: Other family members traveled by plane, but their arrangements were handled separately.
- Observation: Event responsibilities were divided among different people rather than managed by one organizer.

Current Tools and Alternatives

- Behavior: Regularly uses Expedia for flights and travel planning.
- Opinion: Finds existing travel services cost-efficient and values comparing payment options.
- Behavior: Mentioned Afterpay as an option for dividing payments into four installments, although actual use for this event was not confirmed.
- Observation: Uses specialized travel services rather than a dedicated event-planning application.

Challenges and Costs

- Opinion: Cost is the biggest concern when planning or attending events.
- Estimate: Typically spends around $200 in the context of parties.
- Observation: Group expenses, such as drinks, are often shared. Without planning, whoever has money available may end up paying.
- Opinion: Better coordination could help distribute expenses more fairly.

Potential Alternatives and Switching

- Opinion: Suggested an application where users could enter the location, group size, and each person's available budget.

- Observation: Group budgeting and expense coordination appear important to this participant.
- Observation: Existing travel applications already address some needs, so a new application would need to provide additional value.
- Observation: No clear reason for abandoning Expedia or other existing methods was identified.

Interview 2: Family Birthday Party

Event: Nephew's birthday party, approximately one month ago
Role: Helped with decorations and party preparation

Event Experience

- Behavior: Helped organize a birthday party for their nephew, primarily handling decorations.
- Behavior: Family visited multiple stores looking for decorations and specific party supplies.
- Observation: Finding party supplies involved physical shopping rather than using an online planning platform.

Current Tools and Alternatives

- Behavior: Family knows local people who rent tables and chairs and uses those contacts when needed.
- Behavior: The participant was unfamiliar with the exact reservation process for the rentals.
- Behavior: Has used Canva to create invitations, which are then distributed.
- Observation: Relies on a combination of personal contacts, physical stores, and Canva.
- Observation: Familiar rental businesses reduce the need to search for new vendors.

Challenges and Costs

- Behavior: Finding decorations required going from store to store.
- Observation: Searching across multiple physical locations adds steps to the planning process.
- Observation: Different tasks are handled separately, including decorations, rentals, and invitations.
- Observation: No specific time or money estimates were provided, and the participant did not explicitly describe the shopping process as frustrating.

Potential Alternatives and Switching

- Opinion: Reacted positively to the idea of finding party supplies and services through one application.

- Opinion: Believed this would be easier than visiting multiple stores.
- Observation: Centralized vendor information could address part of the participant's current planning process.
- Observation: Existing relationships with rental businesses may make switching unnecessary for some services.
- Observation: Positive feedback followed an explanation of Festivo, so actual willingness to switch remains unknown.

Interview 3: Halloween Party and Invitations

Event: Halloween party, approximately one week ago
Role: Attendee who shared the invitation with friends

Event Experience

- Behavior: Received an invitation to a Halloween party and saved the date.
- Behavior: Shared the invitation with friends.
- Behavior: Prepared their schedule, got ready, and attended the event.
- Observation: Used a simple process for managing attendance without mentioning a dedicated planning application.

Current Tools and Alternatives

- Behavior: Shared an existing invitation with friends, although the method of sharing was not specified.
- Opinion: Would probably use Canva to create invitations if hosting a party.
- Observation: Canva was identified as a possible invitation-design tool, but actual use for this event was not confirmed.
- Observation: Invitation sharing and personal scheduling currently serve the participant's basic attendance needs.

Challenges and Costs

- Opinion: Not knowing how many people will attend is a major concern when hosting.
- Opinion: Unexpected guests could create shortages of food and drinks.
- Opinion: Preparing everything, giving directions, inviting guests, and encouraging attendance can be stressful.
- Estimate: Initially estimated spending around $100 on an event, increasing to approximately $300 when including decorations and supplies.
- Observation: Attendance uncertainty could affect resource planning, although the participant did not describe personally experiencing this problem at a hosted event.

Potential Alternatives and Switching

- Opinion: Responded positively to an application that could create invitations, send them, and provide attendance updates.
- Observation: Invitation and RSVP tracking could address the concerns described about guest attendance.
- Observation: Existing invitation-sharing methods are simple and familiar.
- Observation: No specific frustration with an existing application or actual switching experience was identified.

Overall Interview Observations

- Behavior: Participants currently use different methods depending on the planning task, including Expedia, Canva, physical stores, personal contacts, and informal coordination.
- Observation: None described using one dedicated application to manage an entire event.
- Observation: Existing alternatives include both digital services and established habits or personal relationships.
- Observation: Cost, searching for supplies, and guest coordination emerged as concerns across the interviews, although not every participant experienced each issue.
- Observation: Participants generally responded positively to centralized planning features, but these were hypothetical reactions rather than demonstrated willingness to switch.
- Observation: Festivo would need to offer enough convenience to encourage users to change methods they already know and use.
- Observation: Additional research would help determine actual switching motivations, time savings, and whether users would adopt a centralized application.

Angel Bautista

Field Notes

Interview One:

Event: Sister's wedding in California
Role: Coordinated getting people from El Paso to California

Experience/Workflow:

- Behavior: Coordinated the move from people from El Paso to California for his sisters wedding
- Behavior: Used Expedia as a war of finding cost effective flights
- Observation: Party planning was split amongst those who could help out
- Observation: Interviewee expressed desire for a more comprehensive party planning app but either couldn't find one, or one doesn't target his needs
- Opinion: The biggest issue in party planning is always going to be cost, people want the most perceived value for their money

Problems:

- Behavior: Actively looked into ways of saving money, through Expedia
- Observation: Mentioned split payments as a benefit offered by Expedia
- Obseravtion: Mentioned an average cost of $200 and that cost is something that should be split amongst the group
- Opinion: A better division of responsibilities might make costs feel a bit more manageable
- Opinion: Having some way of sharing responsibilities in our app might make it more worth it for the end user

Miscellanous:

- Observation: Mentioned a desire for a comprehensive app that can help manage location, cost sharing, and attendance of a given party
- Opinion: I think most party planning apps focus on specializing too much on specific issues that the end user doesn't have their needs fully met

Interview Two:
Event: Family birthday Party
Role: Obtaining decorations

Experience/Workflow:

- Behavior: Job was to get decorations for his nephew's birthday party
- Behavior: The decorations they wanted couldn't be received in one place and had to go
- to multiple places to get their supplies
- Observation: They went to the stores physically rather than online? Was this due to personal preference or otherwise?
- Behavior: Leveraged personal relationships to get supplies they needed (chairs and tables)

- Behavior: Uses canva to create invitation to send out
- Opinion: Could the process be streamlined by having the creation of the invitation and sending them out into one process?

Problems:

- Behavior: Getting what you want requires going to a bunch of different places
- Observation: Like the previous interview there was a mentioned separation of responsibilities between people

Miscellanous:

- Observation: Was intrigued by the idea of a centralized app for vending
- Opinion: While Festivo could solve the issue of having to go to multiple stores, how feasible is it to get accurate inventory information from vendors

Interview Three:
Event: Halloween
Role: Attendee

Experience/Workflow:

- Behavior: had the date marked down for the party
- Behavior: Sent out further invitations to other people
- Opinion: Our app should have some functionality that maybe allows for plus ones or the idea that events might be shared
- Behavior: Use of canva for creating event invitations
- Observation: Second mention of Canva as a resource

Problems:

- Behavior: Main concern with attendance, getting people to attend
- Observation: Did note that issues could arise with having proper food and drink
- Opinion: I think this comes from the lack of knowing how many people are properly attending, either with having too much or too little food for guests rather than vending issues

Misellanous:

- Behavior: interested in apps that could keep track of relevant party information
- Observation: Estimation of $300 dollars for party planning

Overall Observations:

- Behavior: The tools used differed based on the role of the person
- Observation: The main issues dealt with organization, although mainly of different elements (cost, attendance, vending)
- Observation: No one every highlighted an app that could accomplish all their goals (no direct competitor) but they all expressed desire for one to exist
- Observation: 3 of the 3 interviews highlighted sharing responsibilities or having specific roles as an intrinsic part of planning parties

- Opinion: While interest in a hypothetical comprehensive app does exist, the issue I believe that stands out is that can someone solution to an issue become itself an issue. For example, if we had cost sharing features to have users pay their share of a party, could that itself turn off prospective users?

Armando Cabrera
CS 5388
Festivo: Sprint 3 Field Notes

These notes are based on three interviews I conducted for Sprint 3. I focused mainly on what each person actually did during a recent event, what they already use to help plan, and what problems or extra steps came up during the process.

Interview 1 — Wedding Travel / Family Coordination

Recent event: Sister's wedding in California
Participant's role: Helped family members get from El Paso to California

What they actually did

- **Behavior:** The participant was responsible for helping a small group of family members get to California for the wedding.
- **Behavior:** Around five people traveled as part of the group they were helping with.
- **Behavior:** Other relatives used flights and handled those arrangements separately.
- **Observation:** The wedding planning was split between different people, with the participant mainly responsible for transportation rather than the whole event.

Tools / Current Methods

- **Behavior:** Uses Expedia when looking for flights and travel options.
- **Opinion:** Likes that services such as Expedia can help compare prices.
- **Behavior:** Brought up Afterpay as an example of spreading a purchase across multiple payments.

Problems / Cost

- **Opinion:** Cost was the main issue they brought up.
- **Estimate:** Said spending around $200 for a party or similar event would be normal.
- **Behavior:** Explained that groups usually have people contribute money toward things such as drinks or other shared expenses.

What stood out to me

- The participant did not really complain about finding vendors.
- Their bigger concern seemed to be money and coordination between people.

- They suggested the idea of entering the number of people, location, and each person's budget into an app.
- Festivo probably would not replace Expedia for travel, but it could organize the parts that Expedia does not cover.
- I did not hear a strong reason why this participant would stop using Expedia.

Interview 2 — Family Birthday / Party Supplies

Recent event: Family birthday party
Participant's role: Helped with decorations and getting things ready

What they actually did

- **Behavior:** Helped prepare decorations for the party.
- **Behavior:** The family looked around for party supplies rather than getting everything from one place.
- **Behavior:** Some items required going to different stores.

Tools / Current Methods

- **Behavior:** The family already knows people who rent out tables and chairs.
- **Behavior:** They normally go through those existing contacts when rentals are needed.
- **Behavior:** The participant did not know exactly how the rental business handles reservations behind the scenes.
- **Behavior:** Canva has been used to make invitations.
- **Behavior:** After making the invitation, they send it out to guests.

Problems / Extra Steps

- **Behavior:** Decorations and supplies required looking in more than one place.
- **Observation:** No specific estimate for time or cost was given in this interview.

What stood out to me

- This interview gave the clearest example of someone having to search in several places for one event.
- The participant liked the idea of seeing party services and supplies together in one app.

- At the same time, their existing relationship with rental businesses already works for them.
- That means Festivo may be most useful for the things they do not already have a trusted contact for.
- Their positive answer about Festivo came after we explained the idea, so I would treat that as an opinion rather than proof that they would actually switch.

Interview 3 — Halloween Party / Guest Attendance

Recent event: Halloween party
Participant's role: Guest who received the invitation and shared it with friends

What they actually did

- **Behavior:** Received an invitation to the party.
- **Behavior:** Saved the date once they got the invitation.
- **Behavior:** Sent the invitation to friends.
- **Behavior:** Planned their schedule around the event and attended.

Tools / Current Methods

- **Behavior:** Used the invitation itself to share the event with friends.
- **Opinion:** Said they would probably use Canva if they needed to make an invitation.

Problems / Cost

- **Opinion:** A major concern when hosting would be not knowing exactly how many people are coming.
- **Opinion:** More guests than expected could mean not having enough food or drinks.
- **Opinion:** They also said getting everything prepared for the day can be stressful.
- **Opinion:** Other problems mentioned included inviting people, communicating directions, and actually getting people to show up.
- **Estimate:** First mentioned around $100 for an event.
- **Estimate:** After considering decorations and additional supplies, the estimate increased to about $300.

What stood out to me

- The biggest opportunity here was not simply making an invitation.
- The more useful feature may be knowing who is actually coming and keeping that information updated.
- The participant liked the idea of an app that could send invitations and track responses.
- Regular invitation sharing already works for simple events, so Festivo would need to make RSVP tracking and planning noticeably more useful than just sending a message.

Notes Across All Three Interviews

After comparing the interviews, a few things stood out to me:

- **Behavior:** Nobody described using one app for every part of planning an event.
- **Behavior:** The tools they already use depend on the task. Examples included Expedia, Canva, local rental contacts, stores, invitations, and informal group coordination.
- Interview 1 made cost and shared spending stand out.
- Interview 2 showed the problem of looking for supplies or services in different places.
- Interview 3 made guest count and RSVP information stand out.
- Vendor searching seems useful, but it does not look like the only problem people have.
- A centralized place for event information may be more valuable than focusing on only one feature.
- Features that seem worth continuing to test are RSVP tracking, invitations, budgeting, shared expenses, vendor discovery, schedules, and planning based on guest count.
- Positive reactions to the Festivo idea were mostly hypothetical. They do not necessarily mean the participants would actually download or switch to the app.
- We still need stronger evidence about what would make someone stop using their current methods and move to a new planning tool.

Gabriel Trevino

Sprint 3

Field Notes

These are my notes from our three interviews. I focused on what each person actually did, the tools they used, and the problems they brought up when planning or attending an event.

Interview 1 – Wedding and Transportation

Event: Sister's wedding in California

Role: Helped family members with transportation

What the participant did -

- Behavior: Helped a group of about five family members travel from el Paso to California for the wedding.
- Behavior: Some relatives flew and made their own arrangements, so different people handled different parts of the wedding.

Tools and current methods -

- Behavior: Uses Expedia to look at flights and compare travel options.
- Opinion: Comparing prices is useful when choosing how to travel.
- Opinion: Mentioned Afterpay as an option for spreading out payments, but did not confirm using it for this wedding.

Problems and costs -

- Opinion: The biggest concern was the cost, not really finding vendors.
- Estimate: Mentioned around $200 as a normal amount to spend on a party or similar event.
- Behavior: Shared costs, like drinks, are sometimes covered by different people contributing money.

What stood out to me -

I noticed this person already has a method that works for comparing travel prices. I do not think Festivo would replace Expedia.

The more useful idea might be helping groups keep track of budgets and who is paying for what.

The participant suggested using information like group size, location, and individual budgets to help with planning.

Interview 2 – Family Birthday Party

Event: Nephew's birthday party

Role: Helped with decorations and preparation

What the participant did -

- Behavior: Helped prepare decorations and find supplies for a family birthday party.
- Behavior: The family had to check different stores to get the items they needed.

Tools and current methods -

- Behavior: Already knows local people who rent tables and chairs, and the family usually contacts them directly.
- Behavior: Has used canva to create invitations and then sends the invitations out to guests.
- Observation: They were not sure how the rental businesses manage reservations.

Problems and extra steps -

- Behavior: Gathering decorations and supplies meant going to more than one location.
- Observation: They did not give an actual estimate for the time or money spent looking for supplies.

What stood out to me -

This interview connected the most with our vendor discovery idea. It might be easier to see nearby rentals, decorations, and other services in one place.

At the same time, the family already has trusted rental contacts, so they might not need festivo for every service.

-Opinion: The participant liked the idea of finding supplies and services in one app, but that does not mean they would definitely switch to it.

Interview 3 – Halloween Party and Attendance

Event: Halloween party

Role: Attended the party and shared the invitation with friends

What the participant did -

- Behavior: Received an invitation, remembered the date, and shared it with friends.
- Behavior: Planned their schedule around the party and attended.

Tools and current methods -

- Behavior: Used the invitation to share the event with other people.
- Opinion: Said they would probably use canva if they needed to create an invitation. this was not confirmed as something they used for this specific party.

Problems and costs -

- Opinion: If they were hosting, not knowing how many people would show up would be a big concern.
- Opinion: More guests than expected could lead to not enough food or drinks, and sharing directions or getting people to attend can be stressful.
- Estimate: First estimated around $100 for an event, then closer to $300 after thinking about decorations and supplies.

What stood out to me -

The participant was talking mainly from a guests point of view, so the attendance problem was a concern they imagined as a host, not an issue they said they experienced themselves.

An RSVp feature could help organizers estimate how many supplies they need, but a simple invitation already works for some events.

Overall Notes from the Three Interviews

All three participants used different methods depending on the event: Expedia, canva, physical stores, personal contacts, or regular invitations.

The biggest issue was different in each interview: money and transportation in the first, supplies and convenience in the second, and attendance in the third.

I noticed that finding vendors was not the main problem for everybody. Some people already know where to go or who to contact.

People seemed interested in having planning information in one place, but we still do not know if they would actually stop using their current tools.

For festivo I think we should keep testing vendor discovery, RSVp tracking, budgeting, and guest-based supply estimates before deciding which features matter most.

Festivo: Spring 3 Field Notes

The following are my field notes for the interviews we performed as a team on 10/18/2026. The interviews allowed us to determine what people are looking for to make their experiense easier when planning events, and what inconveniences they find with the way they organize events now.

Interview 1: The Wedding Logistics

Recent event: Wedding

Participant's role: Assisted with transportation to event.

- Behavior: The interviewee was responsible in organizing family members travel arrangements to California for a wedding
- Behavior: The groups consisted of 5 people
- Observation: The interviewee was only tasked with travel arrangements rather than a number of responsibilities. Perhaps a division of labor was assigned, leaving the interviewee with secondary preparations.

Tools / Current Methods

- Behavior: Mentioned Expedia for flights and traveling arrangements.
- Option: Expedia has pricing alternatives to fit one's needs
- Behavior: Mentioned Afterpay for payment arrangements as a possibility.

Problems / Cost

- Opinion: the cost of the trip was the primary source of concern.
- Estimation: estimated around a $200 average cost for similar expenses and trips was a common expenditure.

What I learned from the Interview:

- There really was no concerns in terms of convenience, whether in finding a vendor or a service.
- Main concern circled around pricing, and our app doesn't really serve as a complete replacement for their current service provider in Expedia.
- There was not a strong enough argument to signal that this interviewee would become a regular consumer of Festivo.

Interview 2 – Family Birthday Accomodations

Recent event: Birthday party

Participant's role: Assisted with organization and reaching out to family/friends for accommodations.

What they did:

- Behavior: assisted with decorations and with reaching out to vendors.
- Behavior: Family looked around for vendors, and places to purchase party supplies and needs.
- Behavior: Went to different stores to get certain items necessary

Tools / Current methods

- Behavior: Family and friends already know places and businesses where they can rent chairs and tables, as well as other necessary things.
- Behavior: The interviewee normally goes through existing contacts or close friends and family for things necessary, such as rentals.
- Behavior: Canva has been used for invitations from fliers.
- Behavior: After an invitation is created, they are provided to those attending an event.

Problems / Extra Steps

- Behavior: Interviewee often had to go to multiple businesses to acquire everything needed for one event.
- Observation: While the interviewee did provide us with an understanding that he wanted more convenience, he did not mention cost or time spent in the planning stage.

What stood out to me

- The longer the interview went, the more that convenience seemed to be the feature that made the app most attractive.
- The interviewee sounded like he was more likely to use his contacts, and perhaps utilize the application if he did not have someone with a contact.

Interview 3 – Halloween Party and Attendance

Recent event: Halloween party

Participant's role: Guest who received an invitation and shared it amongst her friends.

What they did:

- Received an invitation to a party
- Behavior: Kept the date in mind once they received an invitation

- Behavior: re-sent the invitation to friends
- Behavior: Planned schedule around the event and attended the event

Tools / Current Methods

- Behavior: Used the invitation itself to invite other individuals
- Opinion: mentioned Canva as an alternative for invitations

Problems / Cost

- Opinion: A concern when hosting an event was the uncertainty of people attending or not
- Opinion: additional guests could result in not having the necessary drinks or food for everyone, even those that were accounted for
- Opinion: Problems were mentioned with the logistics of inviting people, communicating directions, and getting the people to actually show up.
- Estimate: the person mentioned 100-300$ as an estimate for an event.

What stood out:

- First mentioned $100 for an event, which leads me to believe they haven't really planned many events.
- Problems were mentioned when inviting, communicating, and doing basic things.
- The gust mainly enjoyed the idea of an app for keeping track of invitations and who is attending.

Notes Across All Three Interviews

- People only seemed to find interest in the project once details were mantioned to them in what it would assist them with
- Vendor searching doesn't seem to be the greatest hurdle people are having.
- Tools depend on what the event is, for example the interview where a flight was involved.
- Price wasn't mentioned as often as once thought it would
- We need to determine a strong enough feature or reason to get them to stop using their own methods and use the app instead.